

south from Tennessee. A climactic river battle was fought in sight of the city on June 6. Impressed by the effectiveness of the Confederate rams at Plum Point Bend, the Union flotilla had acquired its own squadron of nine rams—converted tugs rebuilt by Pennsylvania engineer Charles Ellet and crewed by civilian riverboat men. When Montgomery's cottonclad rams steamed out to meet the Union flotilla, cheered on by crowds of spectators on the Memphis bluffs, they were crushed by Ellet's rams and the gunfire of the five remaining Union Pook Turtles. Only one Confederate ship escaped.

1 The number of Union casualties recorded at the naval battle of Memphis. The victim was Charles Ellet, commander of the Union rams, who was fatally wounded. The Confederates lost about 180 men.



The Battle of Memphis

The Confederate cottonclad *CSS General Beauregard* is rammed by *USS Monarch* off Memphis on June 6, 1862. The revival of the ancient naval tactic of ramming was an unexpected result of the use of armored steam ships.

Vicksburg stands firm

With the fall of Memphis, only the Confederate fortress at Vicksburg stood in the way of Union control of the Mississippi. In late June, Farragut's fleet steamed upriver to join the river flotilla in a combined attack on Vicksburg, but their guns made little impression on a determined garrison. On July 15, *CSS Arkansas*, a Confederate ironclad arrived at Vicksburg and sailed through the Union fleet,